

Anthony Gonzalez

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student at East Texas A&M with hands-on experience building security labs, deploying intrusion prevention systems, and simulating offensive and defensive network scenarios in Linux environments. Proficient in Python with applied knowledge of cryptographic hashing, brute-force mitigation, and system hardening. Combines technical skills with over two years of high-pressure customer operations at Costco, bringing strong de-escalation, incident reporting, and problem-solving abilities.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Front-End Associate / Service Assistant | Costco Wholesale | Cypress, TX **Nov. 2023 – Present**

- Resolved complex member issues in a high-volume retail environment through professional de-escalation, clear communication, and rapid problem-solving under pressure.
- Enforced POS and cash-handling security protocols, collaborating with supervisors on critical incident documentation.
- Executed loss prevention procedures and maintained compliance enforcement to ensure a secure operational environment.

PROJECTS

Password Cracking and Hash Analysis Tool | Python, Hashlib, Git/GitHub **2026**

- Designed and developed a Python-based password auditing tool capable of executing dictionary, brute-force, and hybrid attack strategies against MD5, SHA-1, and SHA-256 hash types.
- Implemented cryptographic logic using hashlib, including salted hash generation and comparison functions, to demonstrate the effectiveness of salting as a defense against precomputation attacks.
- Managed the full Git and GitHub workflow across a multi-member team, overseeing feature branching, multi-file merge conflict resolution, pull request reviews, and clean commit history.

Fail2Ban SSH Intrusion Prevention Lab | Ubuntu, Kali Linux, Postfix, iptables **2025**

- Deployed and configured Fail2Ban on Ubuntu with a custom SSH jail.
- Simulated sustained brute-force login attempts from a Kali Linux attack node to trigger, verify, and log automated IP ban enforcement through iptables.
- Configured Postfix with a Gmail SMTP relay to deliver real-time email alerts on ban events, rapidly diagnosing service startup conflicts and misconfigured jail parameters.

Home Network Security Lab | Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Networking **2025**

- Engineered a physical client-server network linking Kali Linux and Ubuntu workstations to simulate dedicated offensive and defensive security nodes in a controlled lab environment.
- Administered cross-distribution file system permissions, user access controls, and CLI environments to maintain secure, stable communication between nodes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Cryptography (Symmetric/Asymmetric), Hashing and Salting, MFA, CIA Triad, Fail2Ban, IPS, iptables, Brute-Force Mitigation

Programming Languages: Python, C++

Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Fedora, Windows, Unix/Linux CLI, VirtualBox

Tools & Methodologies: Git, GitHub, Hashlib, Postfix, Home Lab Configuration

Professional: De-escalation, Incident Reporting, High-Volume Operations, Team Collaboration, Bilingual (English/Spanish)

EDUCATION

East Texas A&M University | Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity **Expected Dec. 2028**

- *Relevant Coursework:* Programming Fundamentals (I, II, III), Introduction to Cybersecurity, Cybersecurity Principles and Practice (CSCI 310), Discrete Mathematics.